

Optional Lab: Build Your First AI-Powered Workspace

When: Over lunch (self-paced, 20-30 minutes)

Difficulty: Beginner

What you need: Claude.ai Pro or Team account

The Scenario

You just got promoted to **Regional Sales Manager** at a mid-size SaaS company. Your VP wants three things by end of week:

1. A summary of last quarter's sales performance
2. A competitive analysis of your top 3 competitors
3. A weekly report template you'll use going forward

You'll use everything from this morning — prompting, settings, data analysis, and Projects — to build a complete workspace that handles this.

Part 1: Set Up Your Project (5 min)

1. Create a new Project called "**Q4 Sales Analysis**"
2. Add these Custom Instructions:

You are helping a Regional Sales Manager analyze SaaS sales data. Always use professional business language.
Format numbers with commas and 2 decimal places for currency.

When showing trends, include percentage changes.
Summarize findings with bullet points followed by a recommendation.

1. Upload the two data files provided:
2. `q4-sales-data.csv` (quarterly sales by rep and region)
3. `competitor-intel.txt` (competitive landscape notes)

Part 2: Analyze the Sales Data (10 min)

Upload `q4-sales-data.csv` and try these prompts. Notice how each builds on the last:

Prompt 1 — Overview:

Analyze this Q4 sales data. What are the top-line numbers? How did we perform overall?

Prompt 2 — Dig Deeper:

Which reps exceeded quota? Which regions underperformed?
Give me the 3 most important insights a VP would want to hear.

Prompt 3 — Create a Deliverable:

Create a one-page Q4 Sales Summary I can email to my VP.
Include: key metrics, top performers, areas of concern, and 3 recommendations for Q1.

Bonus — Chart It:

Create a bar chart artifact comparing revenue by region. Include quota as a reference line.

Part 3: Competitive Analysis (10 min)

Upload `competitor-intel.txt` and try:

Prompt 1:

Based on these competitive notes, create a comparison matrix: us vs. the 3 competitors across pricing, key features, target market, and weaknesses.

Prompt 2:

Write 3 talk tracks I can give my sales team — one for each competitor. Focus on our advantages and their vulnerabilities. Keep each under 100 words.

Prompt 3 — Create a Deliverable:

Create a "Competitive Battle Card" artifact I can print and give to my reps. One page, scannable, with win/loss talking points.

Part 4: Build a Reusable Template (5 min)

Prompt:

Create a Weekly Sales Report template I can reuse. Include sections for: pipeline summary, closed deals, at-risk deals, competitive encounters, and next week priorities. Make it an artifact I can copy into a doc.

Save this in your Project. Next week, you just upload new data and say "fill in this week's report."

What You Practiced

Skill	Where You Used It
Prompting	Every interaction — specific, contextual, iterative
Settings	Your Personal Preferences shaped Claude's tone
Projects	Custom Instructions + uploaded files = persistent context
Data Analysis	CSV upload → insights → deliverables
Artifacts	Summary doc, battle card, report template
Iteration	Each prompt built on the previous answer

Deliverables You Created

By the end of this lab, you have: - ☐ A Q4 Sales Summary (email-ready) - ☐ A Competitive Battle Card (print-ready) - ☐ Sales talk tracks for 3 competitors - ☐ A reusable Weekly Report template - ☐ A Project workspace you can keep using

These are real outputs you'd use at work on Monday.

This lab is optional. If you finish early, try uploading your own work data into a new Project.